The SCP Foundation Wiki presents itself as a collaborative speculative fiction website and an open, welcoming community for writers and readers. A closer examination of its official documentation reveals a highly structured environment with strict rules, rigid procedures, and significant barriers to participation. The Foundation's mission, as stated on the "About" page, is framed as a noble effort to protect humanity from anomalous entities. The wiki describes itself as a collaborative space where anyone can contribute. It emphasizes creativity, community, and shared purpose. The practical reality of participating in the wiki is far more complex. The membership process alone presents multiple hurdles. Prospective members must be at least 18 years old with no exceptions, submit a specific statement acknowledging AI restrictions, and adhere to strict username policies. The application requires explicit acknowledgment that AI-generated content will result in permanent bans. The site rules are comprehensive and strictly enforced. Rule Zero, "Don't be a dick", serves as a broad foundation for staff discretion. The disciplinary process follows a clear escalation path from warnings to permanent bans, with actions like plagiarism, harassment, and threats of legal action potentially resulting in immediate permanent bans. The rules are applied with significant staff authority and limited appeals. The Object Class system is strictly controlled by community consensus. Authors are heavily discouraged from using custom classes. While not technically a hard ban by staff, any custom class that resembles or duplicates an existing standard class will be rejected through community downvotes. For example, using "Neutralized (De Facto)" for an anomaly is likely to be rejected because it is seen as redundant, regardless of the author's intent. The standard classes (Safe, Euclid, Keter, Thaumiel, etc.) are expected. The Explained class uses the -EX suffix. It appears mandatory, and functionally operates as a hard rule, because every single Explained SCP on the wiki uses it. It is enforced through strict formatting standards and community voting. There are no exceptions in practice. Explained = -EX. If an author omits the suffix, the article will be rejected or downvoted for formatting errors, even if no written Site Rule explicitly forbids it. The deletion process demonstrates how easily contributions can be removed. Articles falling to a score of negative 10 trigger deletion procedures. Rule violations can result in immediate removal. Staff have broad authority to delete content, while the system encourages authors to self-delete failing works. This creates a "delete first" culture where articles are disposable. The criticism policy reveals expectations for feedback, requiring helpful, specific critique while discouraging personal attacks and vague responses. This promotes improvement but maintains staff oversight and enforcement. The SCP Wikidot operates as a highly curated, strict environment. The gap between its welcoming rhetoric and

its rigid, enforced rules creates tension for new and established contributors alike. The wiki may be more accurately described as a controlled creative platform rather than the open community it presents itself as. Participation requires compliance with multiple layers of rules, acceptance of significant staff authority, and understanding of deletion risks, making it a challenging environment for casual contributors. The wiki’s rule system is rigid, and the community enforcement makes it illogical.